

Miners Split With Tech

University of Texas at El Paso baseballers split a doubleheader with Texas Tech's Red Raiders Friday, losing the opener 11-3 but coming back with freshman Joel Kuenstlar on the mound to win the nightcap 2-1.

Action continues with another Raider doubleheader Saturday, the first tilt set for noon at the Ysleta cutoff diamond.

Texas Tech got five runs in the second inning of the first game. Miner pitcher Phil Darwin went three innings giving up eight runs on five hits. Gilbert Rodriguez took over in the fourth, was tagged with six runs and relieved by Ernie Carreon.

Frank Del Toro doubled Joel Kuenstlar home during the fourth for the Miners. U.T. El Paso picked up their other two runs the next inning. John Bickley went all the way for the Raider win.

The second game was tied 1-1 until the bottom of the ninth inning when Miner Barry Alburdis took a base-on-balls then advanced to third on Del Toro's single. Second baseman Terry Baker took the sign from Miner coach Andy Cohen, layed down a perfect suicide squeeze bunt and Alburdis beat the throw home giving the Miners a 2-1 victory. Kuenstlar went all the way on the Miners in his first collegiate mound start.